

- ▶ Under “Database Directory”, click the “...” button and browse to a folder on your NAS where you want the UPnP configuration file stored (it doesn’t really matter where this is).
- ▶ Then, head down to Content and click the “...” button to point FreeNAS to the folders you want to share.
- ▶ You can add multiple folders from all over your NAS, and it can stream them as long as they contain movies or music.

Some devices, like the Playstation 3, may require you to transcode your higher-definition videos, so check the “enable transcoding” box if necessary. Then hit “Save”. If you head over to your UPnP device and search for servers, you should see that your NAS pops up, and you can browse your media folders and watch those videos on your TV.

Torrent boxes

Another really cool tool in your networked home is a Torrent Box. Simply put, a torrent box allows you to queue, manage and share all your torrent data via a network connection. This means that you can just leave your old PC running Torrent, in the corner chipping away at your downloads and seeding away, whilst you’re out working on your laptop. You won’t need a monitor once you’ve set up the box, which means you can put it anywhere it will fit.

Setting up

1. It’s always best to start with a fresh operating system, so format and reinstall your chosen OS on the PC’s hard drive.
2. As you’re going to be using the machine to store data, you’ll need a fairly large hard drive depending on your plans. However if you’re using the box as a go-between (before transferring your downloads to shares or backup locations) then space is not so much of an issue.
3. It’s important to remember to format the drive on which you’ll be downloading your torrent data to NTFS, and not the older FAT32 file system. NTFS will allow you to download files greater than 4 GB, a constraint when using FAT32 devices.
4. Make sure you have at least one shared and accessible location from which to access the data. Simply create a folder on your main download drive, right-click and choose “Share”. This is where all your downloaded data will go.